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Project Management 7.2

Project Implementation – Controlling Change with Benefits

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this week, you will be able to:
  - Use Change Control methods in a project
  - State why Change Control is required
  - Discuss Change Control

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So, it’s time to begin implementation…

- Our business case was authorised
- We are clear about what the project has been asked to deliver
- We’ve set up the project team
- The project plan has been written
- Risks and issues have been mitigated (or we have made a conscious decision to ignore)
- We have a process for testing and commissioning.

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Change Control

- But stakeholders may have different ideas:
  - What some of them want today, may change tomorrow
  - Your authorised project may be an easier route to getting what they want done, than trying to get another case authorised
  - The scarce resources in your control may be coveted by others
  - Scope creep results from uncontrolled change to project scope
- Left unchecked, what the project delivers may bear little resemblance to what was agreed (or is expected).

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Uncontrolled Change

- Uncontrolled change affects time, cost and quality:

http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aXQ2lO3ieBA

  - The movie this clip comes from is based on fact; from a book written by the man responsible for project assurance

- Impact assessments.

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Managing Requests For Change

- So we need to manage change
  - A formal process
  - Clear direction on what is agreed
  - Stakeholder engagement
  - A record of authorised changes
  - A control mechanism.

Requests For Change & PRINCE2

- Request Project Board (or Change Authority) response
- Potential Responses
- If a request for change involves extra cost, there are three principal ways to fund it:
  - Use the change budget (if being used and if of sufficient size)
  - Increase the project budget
  - De-scope other elements of the project.
- Tolerance should not be used to fund requests for change.

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Request For Change

- What is the change is and why
- The impact:
  - Time, Cost, Quality, Scope, Benefits, Risk etc
- Sign-off process
- Once change is authorised that becomes the new baseline for the project to achieve
- Once change is authorised the change budget is updated.

Project Board

- The project board has a key role to play throughout the deployment phase
- They ensure the benefits
- Understand the wider organisational context impacted on:
  - Other projects
  - Business as usual.

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Project Board & PRINCE2

- Under PRINCE2 the Project Board is:
  - To provide unified direction to the project and Project Manager
  - To provide the resources and authorize the funds for the project
  - To provide visible and sustained support for the Project Manager
  - To be accountable for the success or failure of the project and will therefore:
    - Approve all major plans and resources
    - Authorise any deviation that exceeds or is forecast to exceed stage tolerances
    - Approve the completion of each stage and authorize the start of the next stage
    - Communicate with other stakeholders.

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Benefits

- Projects are all about benefits… its why we do them
- Projects deliver changed or new capability for the organisation
- The organisation has to change its behaviour in order to leverage that capability
  - The project may facilitate changed behaviour by delivering communication plans, training interventions etc.
- Changed Capability + Changed Behaviour = Benefit.

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Look Forward

- L7.3 The people